

Meeting Name:	Planning Committee Smaller Applications
Date:	21 January 2026
Report title:	Addendum report (adjourned planning application 24/AP/3577: LAND REAR 19-49 BUSH ROAD, LONDON SE8 5AP)
Ward(s) or groups affected:	Rotherhithe
Classification:	Open
Reason for lateness (if applicable):	N/A
From:	Director of Planning and Growth

PURPOSE

1. To advise members of the information set out in paragraph 4 of this report in respect of the following item adjourned at the meeting of 8 December 2025: 24/AP/3577 - LAND REAR 19-49 BUSH ROAD, LONDON SE8 5AP.

RECOMMENDATION

2. That members note and consider the additional information in respect of this item in reaching their decision.

24/AP/3577: LAND REAR 19-49 BUSH ROAD, LONDON SE8 5AP

PROPOSED DEVELOPMENT

Demolition of all existing buildings and construction of 3no. blocks with heights of two, three, and part four storeys, containing commercial space (Use Class E(g)(i) / E(g) (iii), purpose-built student accommodation rooms (Use Class Sui Generis), associated landscaping, service bay and turning areas.

3. This planning application was **adjourned** at the meeting of 8 December 2025 to the next Planning Committee (Smaller Applications) meeting scheduled for 21 January 2026, for officers to:
 1. Address the concerns regarding consultation with neighbouring properties
 2. Engage with Lewisham Council on traffic related issues.

3. Obtain a detailed response from Thames Water.
4. This addendum to the officer report provides clarification on the above issues where additional information was requested and other matters relating to the planning application at 19-49 Bush Road, ref. 24/AP/3577 which was presented to LB Southwark's Planning Committee (Smaller Applications) on 8 December 2025.

Additional consultation

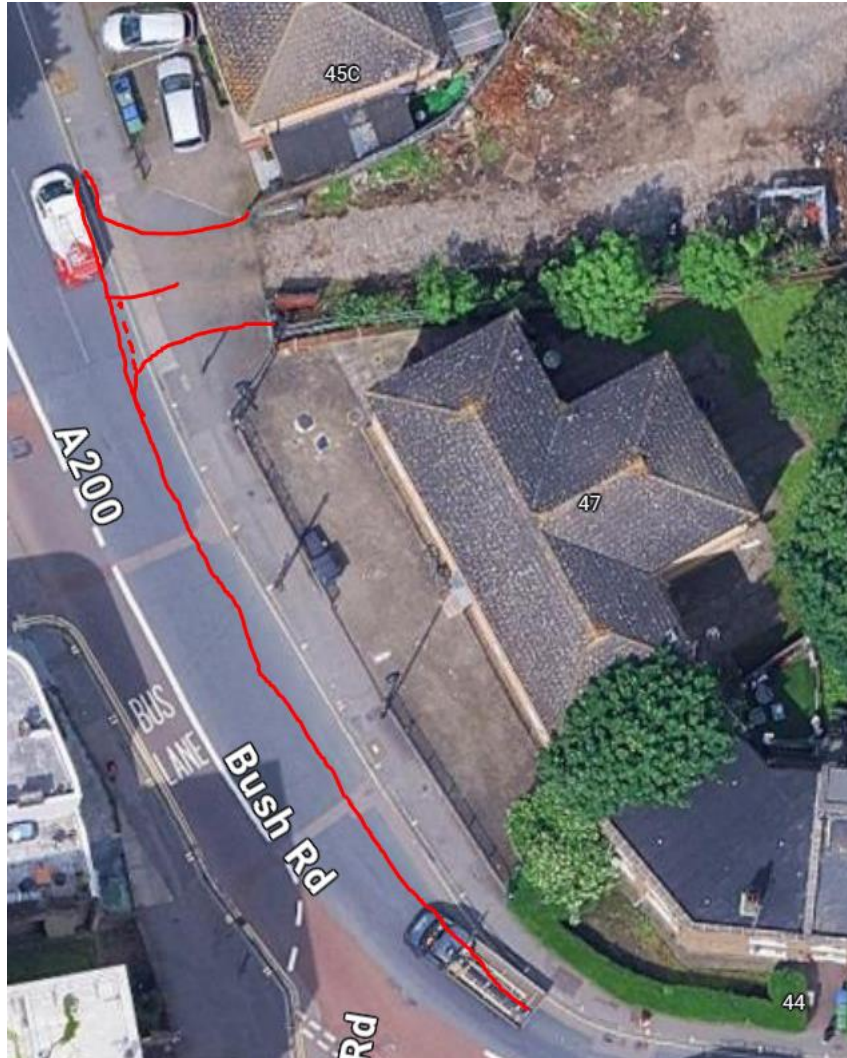
5. 267 additional neighbour letters were sent. No further representations were received.

Highway details

6. Members raised concern to the fact that the London Borough of Lewisham's transport/highways team (LBL) had not been consulted on highway matters on the planning application. Following the December committee meeting, this consultation was undertaken. Below are the comments from the London Borough of Lewisham Highways team with responses/comments from LBS Transport and Highways Team highlighted in red and green respectively:
 - Report suggests PTAL score is 5, however, TfL website has it as a 4 (2023). **This is likely due to the PTAL update which happened after this pre-app/application was submitted. The PTAL is now 4.**
 - Bush Road is part of the A200 which is classed as a principal road in an urban area and is a primary route for large-scale traffic flow. **Noted.**
 - It is mentioned that the speed limit is 20mph but do we have up to date speed data to confirm this? Up to date speed data should be sought to confirm that the SSD and visibility splays being used are in line with the actual data. **This information is not available. 20mph speed is used since it is the borough wide speed limit. In the absence of the actual speed data, the existing configuration of the road layout/site entrance means vehicles travelling at 30mph will have a safe stopping distance (SSD) of 43m.**
 - Agree with the committee report that visibility protection could be an issue. Currently there is a SYL (Mon – Sat, 7am – 7pm), and a loading ban (Mon – Fri, 7am – 10am). Consideration should be given to providing a DYL around the bend to the west of the development entrance, to ensure that visibility is not restricted. **Would Highways consider this? Yes, Highways will consider this during the s278 implementation process. Add 'Introduction of double yellow lines to the west of the site entrance' to the list of highway works**
 - It is noted that the road is a single carriageway with an adjacent bus lane but as driver rounds the bend, the carriageway widens to two lanes, and this may encourage vehicles to speed up and overtake. **Noted.**

- Have we considered in widening the footway to reduce the carriageway width, thus reducing the likelihood of vehicles parking within this area, see very simple sketch below: **We do not consider the below design appropriate, as it will create additional conflict between vehicles and road users (particularly for pedestrians). This does not accord to our Streets for People strategy. The crossover will be SSDM compliant.**
- Should the above be found not to be achievable then consideration should be given to providing new “20mph” roundels, at a point where the carriageway widens with another set at 50m. These new markings will complement the existing markings at the junction with Rotherhithe New Road. **Would Highways consider this? Yes, Highways will consider this during the s278 implementation process. Add’ Introduction of 2no. “20mph roundels at 50m intervals outside the side on Bush Road’ to the list of highway works**
- None of the plans show how the entrance/exit to the development will work. Will be a formal junction with give way lines, what will the road with be, what is radius of the junction, will it have kerbing and tactile paving for pedestrians to cross.etc.? **The scheme is car-free and will generate 12 delivery/servicing trips per day (~1 per hour). We do not feel a give way would be appropriate as the vehicular impacts of this scheme are limited. Instead, the crossover would be SSDM compliant.**
- Agree that if the development needs to be a gated entrance that there should be a minimum of 10m, this will allow two vehicles to queue and be fully clear of the main carriageway before stopping. **There should be no queuing of vehicles outside this development. The scheme is car-free and will generate 12 delivery and servicing trips per day. It is very unlikely that two vehicles will arrive at the development at the same time.**
- Transport Technical Note suggests Delivery and Servicing Management Plan (DSMP), will be undertaken and agree that this needs to be done and included as part of the planning condition. **Noted. Outline DSMP was submitted with the application**
- A Student Move-In / Move-Out Management Plan should also be requested to include for staggered arrivals, temporary stewarding on peak days, off-site marshalling (if required). **This has been requested and will be conditioned. The general delivery and servicing strategy has been outlined in the submitted DSMP.**
- There is no pedestrian/cycle crossing point across Bush Road, the closest crossing points are at the junction with Rotherhithe New Road, to the north. While the bus stop audit shows that pedestrians will have to walk approx. 170m to reach Bus Stop N, by using the crossing at Rotherhithe New Road, should we not be looking to improve the experience for pedestrians/cyclists to be able to directly access Bus Stop N. There is a high probability that both pedestrians and cyclists will look to cross the

road at the bus stop, rather than walk the 170m. We would not consider these changes to be commensurate with the impact of this development (108 bed, car-free scheme). The applicant is unlikely to agree to a S106 contribution as it won't meet the legal tests.



Bend along Bush Road towards Development site

7. As highlighted above, the LBS Transport Policy and Highways Teams have reviewed the comments and measures suggested by officers at Lewisham. Their conclusion is that, overall, the proposed development is acceptable in highways terms, subject to conditions. Up to 6 vehicle movements a day (12 trips) are expected in relation to the proposed development. This represents a reduction of approximately 57 movements compared to the previous plant and machinery hire use. The specific comments are:
 - The widths of the vehicular and pedestrian accesses are suitable for all anticipated users and vehicles.

- The gate is set back 6.3m from the back of the footway and 8.5m from the carriageway. This provides sufficient area for vehicles to wait on entry to the Site, avoiding obstruction of the carriageway. The gate will be automatically operated. Further details on the gate operation will be secured by condition.
 - The southern access is approximately 35m from the Bush Road / Bestwood Road junction and provides sufficient visibility to maintain highways safety.
 - With respect to double yellow lines around the bend to the west of the site, Highways will consider this during the S278 implementation process. Highways will also consider the introduction of 2 no. 20mph roundels at 50m intervals outside the site on Bush Road. These interventions are considered commensurate with the scale and impact of the scheme.
 - Officers note the comments regarding footway widening, give way lines, road width, kerbing, crossing points, etc. The Transport Policy team does not consider these measures appropriate for a car-free 108-bed PBSA development. The additional measures are not proportionate and would therefore not meet the legal tests for developer contributions. The predicted uplift in delivery and servicing trips is 12 per day, making it highly unlikely that multiple vehicles will be on-site at any given time. No queuing to enter the site is expected.
 - The LBS Lewisham suggested design, with give way lines would create additional conflict between vehicles and road users, particularly for pedestrians, which does not accord to our Walking Plan or Streets for People strategy. An SSDM-compliant crossover will be adequate to manage vehicle movements in and out of the site.
 - An outline DSMP was provided at application stage. The full DSMP and a Student Move-in/Move-out plan has been requested and will be conditioned.
 - The PTAL score will be updated in line with TfL's most recent data (rating of 4).
8. The applicant is willing to agree to the above measures including providing road markings and signage to help improve highway safety on Bush Road, as well as the provision of a Stage 2 Road Safety Audit as part of the detailed design for highways works.

Thames Water, water supply, and drainage

9. Thames Water initially provided a response to the Proposed Development in January 2025, in which they raised no objection to the Proposed Development on the basis of sewer capacity or water supply. Following the December

committee meeting, Thames Water were consulted again for further comment. They provided the following response on 15 December 2025:

“Thank you for consulting Thames Water on this planning application. Having reviewed the details, we have no comments to make at this time as there are no change from previous response issued on 27th November, so there are no further concerns to this site that may be affected.

Should the details of the application change, we would welcome the opportunity to be re-consulted.”

10. Additionally, the applicant has undertaken a flow and pressure test at the south end of Bush Road. A Hydrant Test Certificate has been provided which confirms that the testing results meet the requirements set out in Thames Water’s response (minimum pressure of approx. 1 bar and a flow rate of 9 litres/minute at the point where it leaves Thames Water pipes).
11. The applicant has also clarified that adequate water pressure would be provided to the proposed student rooms using a system of buffer vessels, pumps, and break tanks. While it is not a planning consideration, this is understood to be a typical solution in areas of low water pressure.
12. Officers do not consider that there are any material grounds to object to the proposed development relating to water pressure.
13. Officers note that that proposed development would reduce surface water runoff from the Site from an existing rate of 50l/s to a proposed rate of 2.5l/s. This will significantly reduce strain on the existing sewer system.

Viability policy and compliance

14. Following the meeting, officers re-consulted planning policy colleagues to confirm the viability position. The Planning Policy Manager confirmed the following in response:

“On this basis, if the case officer is satisfied that the calculation and the policy requirement for viability testing has been met and agreed by the council, then this would seem to be a ‘compliant’ scheme.”

15. To recap, the policy position is clarified below:
 - Policy P5 of the Southwark Plan states that the affordable provision within student developments should be 35%, subject to viability.
 - The development’s viability is to be considered against the 2025 Affordable Housing SPD, referenced in paragraph 48 of the Officer’s Report.

- The reference to the now-superseded 2011 SPD at paragraph 47 is provided for context as to how the final sum was arrived at, as this document was in force at the time that the application was submitted.
- Irrespective of these references, it is the 2025 SPD which is to be afforded weight in the determination of the application.
- The 2025 SPD states that applicants are required to submit a viability assessment with their planning application when providing affordable housing to ensure the maximum proportion of affordable housing is negotiated on each development.
- Officers reviewed the Applicant's viability evidence and concluded that the maximum viable contribution would be £3,200,550. Subsequently, the Applicant offered an increased sum of £3,710,000 (equivalent to 27% as per the 2025 SPD), which is agreed to be the maximum viable figure. As such, it complies with Policy P5.
- The Applicant offer of an increased sum represents a commercial decision and enhances the planning benefits associated with the proposal.
- As demonstrated by the 2019 application, on-site provision is unviable primarily due to the Site's size and associated constraints. Off-site provision is also not possible, given the Applicant lack of suitable sites in their ownership or under contract. A large proportion of land adjacent to the development site is within Lewisham, which constrains availability of prospective sites.
- Therefore, officers consider that the proposed affordable housing contribution is fully compliant with Southwark Plan Policies P1 and P5 and the 2025 SPD.

Design guidance

16. Additional clarification was sought as to the design guidance relevant to the Proposed Development. The following is noted.
 - Paragraph 80 of the Officer's Report references the Residential Design Standards SPD with regard to policy regarding backland development. This SPD is no longer in force and has no weight.
 - Notwithstanding this, it is noted that officers considered the proposed development to comply with guidance relating to backland development when this was in active use.
 - The proposed massing is considered below, with reference to the 2019 "Aros" scheme.

Conclusion of the Director of Planning and Growth

17. Having taken into account the additional information, following consideration of the issues raised, the recommendation remains that planning permission should be granted, subject to conditions as amended in this addendum report and completion of a s106 agreement.

Reason for urgency

18. N/A

Reason for lateness

19. N/A

BACKGROUND DOCUMENTS

Background Papers	Held At	Contact
Individual files	Planning and Growth Direcotrate, Resources Department 160 Tooley Street London SE1 2QH	Planning enquiries Telephone: 020 7525 5403